

Cover letter — BMC Bioinformatics

[DATE REQUIRED]

Dear Editors of BMC Bioinformatics,

Please consider our manuscript, “ViralSafeTarget: evidence-aware, virus-first CRISPR target prioritization with an exhaustive HSV-2 case study,” as a Software Article.

The software addresses a broad bioinformatics need: moving from viral genomes to an auditable research shortlist while keeping viral conservation, model-bounded host search, guide rank, gene targetability, predicted coding disruption, evidence provenance and exact-target multiplex robustness explicit. The manuscript includes an exhaustive HSV-2 case study, a direct frozen-panel comparison with Cas-OFFinder and CRISPRitz, sensitivity analysis, an installed-wheel portability test and a second-virus operational check.

The work fits the journal’s scope in sequence analysis, comparative genomics and reproducible software. The public MIT-licensed repository and source archive permit anonymous reviewer testing. We do not claim experimental editing, safety, viral inhibition, delivery, treatment or cure.

The authors declare no competing interests. [AUTHOR CONFIRMATION REQUIRED] All authors have approved the manuscript and its submission. [AUTHOR CONFIRMATION REQUIRED] The manuscript has not been published or submitted elsewhere. [AUTHOR CONFIRMATION REQUIRED]

Sincerely,

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